

Hudson commissioners OK ALPR cameras in Hoboken after Weehawken effort derailed

By **Dan Israel** - June 24, 2026 6:21 pm

The Hudson County Board of Commissioners unanimously approved (9-0) automated license plate reader (ALPR) cameras proposed to be installed on light poles under county jurisdiction in Hoboken yesterday after a similar effort in Weehawken failed this year.

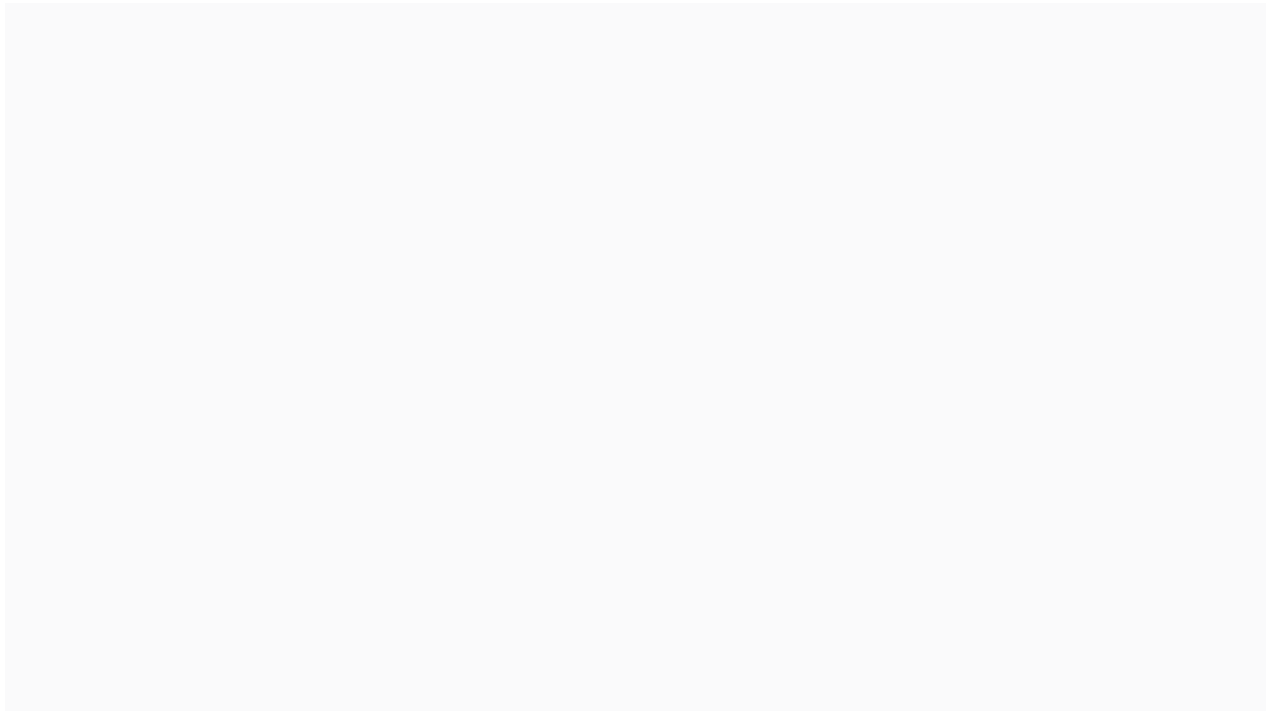


Photo via Traffic Technology Today.

By Dan Israel/Hudson County View

Commissioner Bill O’Dea (D-2) told HCV he wasn’t sure why no members of the public voiced objections to the resolution, despite the same resolution for Weehawken drawing several comments.

Meanwhile, Board Chair Anthony Romano (D-5) defended the cameras approved on county-owned traffic signal poles and mast arms in Hoboken as unrelated to anything pertaining to U.S. Immigrations and Customs Enforcement (ICE), which came up previously.

“It’s more of a proactive thing. There’s a car theft issue. And the parking authority dealing with vehicles that don’t have residential parking permits. They’re very strict with that when it comes to residential permit parking. And that’s basically what it is,” he stated.

He repeated that the cameras will be used specifically to address vehicle theft and enforce parking violations, not assist ICE in civil immigration enforcement.

"I don't see any negative to it because you could only access it for those reasons," he said.

"It's not to get personal information. It is very basic, to ensure that the vehicle is not stolen. Or in the case of the parking authority, to ensure that it's registered or else it has to be issued a summons."

Speculating on why there was no public outcry about this resolution as opposed to the nixed ALPR cameras proposed in Weehawken, Romano emphasized these cameras were strictly for parking enforcement and identifying stolen vehicles.

"I think as the advocates learned more about it, what can be and what information cannot be gathered, I think that gave them more of a feeling of comfortability. Because again, it's the balance," he surmised.

"When I was a policemen, when license plate readers were in their infancy, because I'm retired like twelve years, license plate readers were amazing. Hoboken's location, even Weehawken, we're close to the tunnels. One night, I remember it was two or three cars that were stolen right by the firehouse."

The saga began in April, when advocates against raised concerns over data privacy and ICE actions as a result of utilizing ALPRs.

The board, hearing advocates' criticisms that ICE could be using the cameras for civil immigration enforcement amid other data privacy worries, [carried the resolution](#) on April 9th to the next meeting.

At the April 23rd meeting, the board [pulled the resolution off](#) the agenda at the request of Weehawken Mayor Richard Turner, also to the praise of activists.

However, the resolution was withdrawn before advocates could speak out on the measure, even in support, prompting heated discussion from the board over if they should change procedural rules to prevent that from happening in the future.

While the activists succeeded in persuading the board to nix the resolution, many were frustrated they prepared remarks and attended the meeting only to be told [they couldn't speak](#) on what they rallied to have removed.

At the next meeting on May 14th, O'Dea introduced an ordinance to make the necessary changes to [always allow public comment](#) on agenda items prior to their removal by the board.

While it initially seemed like a long-shot given some initial pushback from the board, the ordinance was adopted at its May 28 meeting [by a unanimous vote](#) (9-0).

Dan Israel